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Unit 5

Alkali and Alkaline Earth Metals

3RN21K



Rock salt



Sylvite



Spodumene

Learning Objectives

After studying this unit, students will be able to

- Explain the properties of alkali metals and alkaline earth metals
- Recognise the anomalous properties of Li and Be
- List the uses of alkali metals and alkaline earth metals
- Describe the general characteristics of compounds of alkali metals and alkaline earth metals
- Appreciate the biological importance of sodium and potassium, Magnesium and Calcium
- Explain the preparation, properties and uses of calcium oxide, calcium hydroxide, gypsum and plaster of paris.